

MARIA ELENA GUTIERREZ, RN, BSN, CCRN
2847 Westwood Avenue, Apt 12B | Cincinnati, OH 45220
(513) 847-2206 | maria.gutierrez.rn@gmail.com | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/megutierrez-rn

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Critical-care registered nurse with seven years of progressive experience in high-acuity medical-surgical, cardiac, and neurosurgical intensive care settings. Proven track record of mentoring new graduate nurses, leading unit-based quality improvement initiatives, and maintaining consistent patient satisfaction scores above the 90th percentile. Dual certification in Critical Care (CCRN) and Advanced Cardiac Life Support (ACLS), with additional credentialing as a stroke-ready nurse (NIHSS-certified) and Preceptor of the Year recipient at University Hospital. Seeking to leverage clinical expertise, evidence-based practice leadership, and interprofessional collaboration skills in a senior clinical or nurse educator role.

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

University of Cincinnati Medical Center — Cincinnati, OH
Critical Care Registered Nurse, Neuroscience ICU (NSICU)
June 2020 – Present

- Deliver comprehensive nursing care to an average of 2,800 post-operative neurosurgical and acute stroke patients annually, including craniotomies, spinal fusions, and external ventricular drain management.
- Achieved 98% adherence to the institution's stroke core measures bundle (door-to-CT within 25 minutes, tPA administration within 60 minutes) across four consecutive Joint Commission survey cycles.
- Charge nurse on rotating weekends, coordinating staffing assignments, bed control, and rapid response activations for a 24-bed unit with a 92% average daily census.
- Selected as one of six NSICU nurses (out of 78) to pilot the Continuous EEG monitoring program, reducing subclinical seizure detection time by an average of 4.2 hours.
- Precepted 19 new graduate nurses over four years, with a 100% first-attempt NCLEX pass rate among mentees and a 96% two-year retention rate on the unit.
- Authored and implemented a unit fall-prevention protocol that decreased patient falls with injury from 2.1 per 1,000 patient days to 0.6 per 1,000 patient days within 12 months.
- Served on the hospital's Sepsis Committee, contributing to a system-wide initiative that improved early sepsis bundle compliance from 61% to 84% over 18 months.

TriHealth Good Samaritan Hospital — Cincinnati, OH
Cardiac Intensive Care Unit Registered Nurse
August 2018 – June 2020

- Cared for post-cardiac surgery patients, including CABG, valve replacements, and LVAD implantations, with a typical 1:2 nurse-to-patient ratio.
- Recognized by the unit's Patient Experience Council for maintaining HCAHPS "Communication with Nurses" scores in the 99th percentile for nine consecutive quarters.
- Mentored two nursing students each semester from the University of Cincinnati and Xavier University, evaluating clinical competencies and providing weekly written feedback.
- Participated in the rollout of the Epic EHR system on the unit, serving as a super-user and training 42 staff nurses on new documentation workflows.

Cincinnati Children's Hospital Medical Center — Cincinnati, OH
Float Pool Registered Nurse, Pediatric Medical-Surgical
July 2017 – August 2018

- Floated between six pediatric units including hematology/oncology, pulmonary, and adolescent medicine, caring for patients ranging from neonates to young adults.

- Achieved Pediatric Advanced Life Support (PALS) certification within first six months of hire to support emergent coverage across the medical center.
- Received the "Rising Star" peer recognition award in Q2 2018 for clinical excellence during a high-volume influenza surge.

PROJECTS & EVIDENCE-BASED INITIATIVES

NSICU Mobility Improvement Initiative ("Move to Improve")

March 2022 – December 2022

- Co-led a unit-based quality improvement project to address early mobility deficits in post-craniotomy patients. Collaborated with physical therapy and neurosurgery to develop a tiered ambulation protocol (Levels 1-3) initiated within 24 hours of stable neurological exam.
- Outcome: Increased documented out-of-bed activity among eligible patients from 34% to 71% over nine months; presented findings at the 2023 Ohio Nurses Association Annual Convention.

CLABSI Reduction Task Force, University Hospital

September 2021 – Ongoing

- Member of a 12-nurse interdisciplinary team tasked with reducing central line-associated bloodstream infections (CLABSI) in the NSICU.
- Authored the unit's updated chlorhexidine bathing policy and championed daily CHG bath compliance audits during morning huddles.
- Outcome: NSICU CLABSI rate decreased from 1.8 infections per 1,000 catheter days (FY2021) to 0.7 per 1,000 catheter days (FY2023), exceeding National Healthcare Safety Network (NHSN) benchmark targets.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Nursing (BSN)

University of Cincinnati, College of Nursing — Cincinnati, OH

Graduated May 2017 | Cum laude | GPA: 3.78/4.0

- Clinical Rotations: Medical-Surgical (The Christ Hospital), Pediatrics (Cincinnati Children's), OB/Labor & Delivery (University of Cincinnati Medical Center), Psychiatric/Mental Health (Cincinnati VA Medical Center), Community Health (Cincinnati Health Department).
- Senior Capstone: 120-hour preceptorship in the University Hospital NSICU under the supervision of Dr. Karen Park, DNP, RN, CNRN.

Associate of Science in Nursing (ADN) — prerequisite coursework

Cincinnati State Technical and Community College — Cincinnati, OH

Completed December 2015

LICENSES & CERTIFICATIONS

- Registered Nurse License, Ohio Board of Nursing, RN.421893, expires October 2025
- Critical Care Registered Nurse (CCRN), American Association of Critical-Care Nurses, expires December 2026
- Advanced Cardiac Life Support (ACLS), American Heart Association, expires March 2026
- Basic Life Support (BLS) for Healthcare Providers, American Heart Association, expires March 2026
- Pediatric Advanced Life Support (PALS), American Heart Association, expires July 2025
- NIH Stroke Scale (NIHSS) Certification, expires April 2026
- Trauma Nursing Core Course (TNCC), Emergency Nurses Association, expires November 2025

CONTINUING EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- ENA Emergency Nursing Conference, Indianapolis, IN — October 2023 (16 contact hours)
- AACN National Teaching Institute (NTI), Philadelphia, PA — May 2023 (24 contact hours)
- NIHSS Recertification Training, Cincinnati, OH — April 2024 (8 contact hours)
- Comprehensive Stroke Care Symposium, Ohio State University, Columbus, OH — February 2023 (12 contact hours)
- Heart Rhythm Society Annual Scientific Sessions — Cardiac Rhythm review course, virtual — June 2022 (10 contact hours)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- American Association of Critical-Care Nurses (AACN), member since 2019
- Ohio Nurses Association, member since 2018
- Sigma Theta Tau International Honor Society of Nursing, Kappa Theta Chapter, inducted 2016

SKILLS

Clinical Skills: Ventilator management, arterial line monitoring, central line care and dressing changes, intracranial pressure monitoring, ventricular drain management, titration of vasoactive drips (vasopressin, norepinephrine, propofol, fentanyl), hemodynamics, post-operative cardiac and neurosurgical care, chest tube management, continuous EEG monitoring, isolation precautions, blood product administration, palliative care conversations, end-of-life support.

Technical/Workflow: Epic EHR (super-user level), Cerner Millennium, Alaris IV pump infusion systems, Pyxis automated dispensing, Midas+ care management, Miya Precision bedside monitoring, Microsoft Office Suite, Microsoft Teams, Zoom.

Interpersonal: Patient and family-centered communication, interdisciplinary collaboration, mentorship and preceptorship, de-escalation, clinical education, bedside shift report, hourly rounding.